15.21 Postpartum Depression

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I cry all the time and feel I am a bad mother." **Objective** • Tearful and withdrawn 3 weeks after the birth • Scores high on depression screening • Not looking after herself	**ACTUAL** **Ineffective coping** related to postpartum mood changes and demands of infant care as evidenced by tearfulness, withdrawal and negative self-statements.	Talks about her feelings and accepts treatment and support.	• Screen with a validated tool (the Edinburgh scale, for example). • Ask her directly about any thoughts of harming herself or the baby, and refer urgently if she has them. • Refer to mental health services. • Bring the family in to support her and help with the baby.	Accepts support and treatment: **goal met**.
Subjective • "I cannot sleep even when the baby sleeps." **Objective** • Cannot sleep • Exhausted	**ACTUAL** **Disturbed sleep pattern** related to low mood and anxiety as evidenced by inability to sleep.	Within 1 week, says she sleeps better.	• Arrange for family to help with night feeds. • Encourage her to rest when the baby sleeps. • Give the prescribed medication if ordered.	Sleeping better: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Mood low • Little support around her	**RISK** **Risk for impaired parenting** as evidenced by risk factors: maternal depression and lack of support.	Baby gets safe and adequate care.	• Watch how mother and baby interact. • Arrange home visits. • Bring in family and community support.	Baby cared for safely: **goal met**.